

MAJID MUMTAZ, CIA, ACA, FCCA

Group Director of Internal Audit & GRC

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Group Director of Internal Audit and GRC with over 20 years of experience, including 15 years across the GCC. Trusted advisor to Boards and Audit Committees, with a mandate spanning complex special investigations, ethics programme ownership, and cybersecurity vendor governance. Known for closing the gap between governance frameworks and business reality, and for deploying AI-enabled monitoring capabilities that move audit coverage from statistical sampling to full-population assurance.

This work has recovered AED 7.7M in revenue leakage, neutralized SAR 15M in hidden M&A risk, and strengthened governance across complex multi-sector GCC portfolios — each engagement repositioning internal audit as a commercial risk intelligence function rather than a compliance cost centre.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Veritux Consulting Network

Dubai, UAE

Senior Advisor, Internal Audit & Risk

Jul 2025 – May 2026

- **Board-Level Governance Advisory:** Engaged by CFOs and Boards to design financial governance structures across multi-sector operations, addressing regulatory risk and strengthening financial control environments.
- **Forensic Audit & ML Risk Engine:** Directed the deployment of an ML risk engine to monitor SAR 500M+ in CapEx and OpEx across a KSA real estate developer's portfolio; identified procurement and payment anomalies that recovered SAR 3.2M annually, at a coverage level conventional sampling could not match.

Kitopi

Dubai, UAE

Director of GRC & Internal Audit

Jun 2022 – May 2025

- **Function Leadership:** Built and led the GRC and internal audit function from the ground up; structured a team of 5 (including 1 manager) covering operational risk, IT governance, ethics, and special investigations; designed and executed the risk-based annual audit plan, presenting risk assessment outcomes and plan coverage directly to the Audit Committee.
- **Operational Risk Assurance:** Designed the audit assurance strategy; leveraged ML anomaly detection and Deep Learning OCR to achieve full-population invoice coverage during a 340% surge in transaction volume; reduced fraud incidents by 78%, with programme outcomes and fraud metrics presented to the Audit Committee on a quarterly basis.
- **IT Governance & Cybersecurity Assurance:** Designed the ITGC framework for a rapidly scaling cloud platform; directed group-wide cybersecurity assessments and penetration testing, translating technical vulnerability findings into Board-level risk briefings and remediation plans.
- **IPO Governance Readiness:** Established the ICFR programme from scratch for the pre-IPO roadmap; EY's external readiness attestation confirmed zero material weaknesses and zero significant deficiencies.
- **Ethics Programme & Whistleblowing:** Owned the Group's ethics and whistleblowing programme end-to-end: led competitive selection of NAVEX EthicsPoint, designed the case management framework and escalation protocol, and reported case status directly to the Audit Committee; led executive engagement on investigations and corrective actions.

- **Special Investigations:** Led multiple sensitive internal investigations, including a CAPEX governance breach inquiry; managed investigation design, evidence handling, and executive reporting while maintaining auditor independence throughout.
- **Commercial Integrity Monitoring:** Recovered AED 3.2M in vendor overcharges and neutralized AED 4.5M in future exposure through automated, continuous monitoring.
- **Audit Transformation:** Directed the build-out of a continuous transaction monitoring capability across seven audit domains, covering flagging logic, workflow routing, and exception reporting; shifted the function from periodic reviews to ongoing real-time monitoring; maintained management action tracking through to closure, with overdue items escalated directly to the Audit Committee.

Al-Faisaliah Group (JSC)

Riyadh, KSA

Diversified Conglomerate: F&B, FMCG, Retail, Healthcare & Pharma

Group Director of Internal Audit & Risk

Nov 2016 – May 2022

- **M&A Due Diligence:** Led internal due diligence on a \$127M acquisition, identifying SAR 15M in undisclosed litigation exposure; findings were used to renegotiate terms before closing.
- **Function Professionalization:** Grew the internal audit team from 3 to 20 professionals, managing the department budget and resource allocation across a five-sector portfolio; achieved the IIA 'Generally Conforms' rating on external quality assessment.
- **Enterprise Risk Management (ERM):** Built a Board-commissioned ERM framework consolidating risk exposure across five sectors, giving the Group its first unified view of portfolio-wide risk; presented consolidated risk status and findings to the Audit Committee on a quarterly basis.
- **Special Investigations:** Led multiple special investigations across the Group's portfolio, covering procurement irregularities, supplier conduct, and related-party concerns; managed each case from intake and forensic review through to Audit Committee reporting and remediation tracking, independent of management.
- **Cybersecurity Vendor Governance:** Led the competitive selection and onboarding of AT&T as Group MSSP, overseeing vendor evaluation, contractual terms, and ongoing SLA performance; the engagement substantially hardened the Group's security posture and data protection frameworks.
- **Financial Controls (ICFR):** Designed and implemented the ICFR programme for the Group's F&B subsidiary, establishing its first structured financial reporting control environment and testing protocols.
- **Fraud Prevention & Detection:** Generated SAR 4.2M in annual savings through predictive ML-enabled monitoring of procurement and supplier payment processes.
- **Digital Governance Transformation:** Directed audit oversight of a Group-wide G-Suite to Microsoft 365 migration, ensuring data integrity, security resilience, and post-migration compliance across a highly diversified portfolio.

EARLIER CAREER & BIG 4 FOUNDATION

Manager, Internal Audit McDonald's Saudi Arabia	2014 – 2016
Internal Audit Manager KPMG (Qatar)	2011 – 2013
AVP, Internal Audit BMA Asset Management	2010 – 2011
Audit Manager Ernst & Young (Karachi, Pakistan)	2004 – 2009

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

- The CFO Is the Audit Independence Risk You're Not Managing, *GRC Report*
- Keeping Risk Registers Relevant, *ACCA AB Magazine*
- FCPA Compliance Programs Are Missing Important Nuances about how Bribery Works in the Persian Gulf, *Corporate Compliance Insights*

- Teaching an Algorithm to Filter False Flags, *IIA Internal Auditor Magazine (Voices)*
- AI Authorization Is Not AI Accountability, *GRC Report*
- The Risk of Algorithmic Entropy: When AI Models Age Faster Than Evolving Fraud, *Consultancy ME*

EDUCATION, CREDENTIALS & EXPERTISE

Core Credentials: CIA, ACA, FCCA | **Degree:** B.Com (Karachi University)

Governance & Audit Frameworks: IIA Standards | COSO ERM & ISO 31000 | ICFR / SOX | COBIT | ISO 27001 | NIST CSF | Third-Party Risk | Forensic Investigations | Cyber-security Assurance

Audit Technology: AI/ML-enabled continuous monitoring | Deep Learning OCR | Python-based automation | NAVEX EthicsPoint | ITGC & Cloud Governance | SAP | Oracle | O365/G-Suite

Executive Certifications:

- Certificate in Disruptive Strategy (Harvard Business School Online)
- Enterprise Risk Management Certificate (COSO)
- Information Systems Auditing & IT Governance (HKUST)
- Machine Learning with Python (IBM)
- Forensic Accounting and Fraud Examination (WVU)
- Risk Management Specialization (NYIF)